

Data Team Instructions

How to prepare our company's module data for the chatbot

Item	Detail
Version / date	1.0 · 29 September 2026
For	The data team preparing the knowledge the chatbot answers from
You will deliver	Per module: one knowledge document (.md or Word) + one Q&A workbook (.xlsx, with its glossary sheet)
Templates (same folder)	SyteLine_Module_Knowledge_Template.md / .docx · SyteLine_QA_Template.xlsx · example_credit.md (filled example)
Tools	python -m scripts.validate_knowledge_data (check) · python -m scripts.convert_docx_to_md (Word → Markdown)

1. Why we need your data

The chatbot works today, but everything it knows was written as a generic example. It must now answer from OUR company's real processes, forms, codes, roles and error messages. The chatbot never uses outside knowledge: if something is not in your files, it says it doesn't know. So the quality of its answers is exactly the quality of these files.

The one rule to remember

Write it the way a colleague would explain it to a new user — in our words, with our form names, our steps and our rules. If you are not sure, write [NEEDS CONFIRMATION] instead of guessing.

2. What you deliver, per module

File	Template	What it contains	Name it
Knowledge document	SyteLine_Module_Knowledge_Template.md (or the .docx)	How the module works: purpose, roles, forms, fields, step-by-step tasks, statuses, rules, what comes next, common problems, glossary	credit.md
Q&A workbook	SyteLine_QA_Template.xlsx	The questions users ask most, with short approved answers, other ways of asking, and the module's glossary	credit.xlsx

- **Same name for both files:** the module id in lower case with underscores (table in section 4).
- **One module per file.** Don't mix two modules in one document.
- **Start from the filled example** example_credit.md — it shows the level of detail we expect.

3. How the chatbot uses your files

Knowing this makes the rules below obvious:

Your file	What the chatbot does with it	So you should...
Knowledge document	Splits it at every ## heading into sections. For each question it finds the 6 best sections and writes the answer ONLY from them. A second check then removes any statement not found in those sections.	Keep one topic per section, and write every step, field and rule you want the chatbot to say.
Section Summary / Keywords	Used to find the right section.	Put the words USERS type in Keywords, including slang and abbreviations.
Q&A workbook	If a question matches an APPROVED row closely, that answer is shown word for word.	Keep answers short and exact; they are shown as written.
Question variations	Every variation is searched, so any of them finds the row.	Add at least 3 real ways people ask.
Glossary	Teaches the chatbot our terms: 'SO' also searches 'Customer Order'.	Add every nickname and abbreviation.

4. Modules and file names

Please deliver in priority order — priority 1 modules get the most questions.

File name	Module	What it covers	Priority
prospect	Prospect	A company that might buy but is not a customer yet.	3

File name	Module	What it covers	Priority
lead	Lead	A record that someone is interested: source, quality, status.	3
opportunity	Opportunity	A qualified chance to sell, with stage, probability and expected value.	3
estimate	Estimate	Internal working record for pricing and configuring what will be offered.	2
quotation	Quotation	The proposal sent to the prospect or customer, usually printed from the estimate.	2
customer	Customer	Master record: bill-to, ship-to, terms, credit limit, defaults.	2
customer_order	Customer Order	Sales order header: customer, dates, terms, status, holds.	1
customer_order_line	Order Lines & Releases	What items, quantities and delivery dates are sold.	1
pricing	Pricing & Discounts	Price lists, price codes and discounts used on estimates and orders.	2
credit	Credit Review & Hold	Credit limit and credit hold rules that can block shipping.	1
shipment	Fulfillment & Shipment	Picking, packing and shipping order lines; stock availability.	1
invoice	Invoice & Credit Memo	Billing the customer for shipped lines; credit memos for corrections.	1
payment	Payment & A/R	Receiving money and applying it to open invoices.	2
returns_and_corrections	Returns & Corrections	RMAs, credits and fixing mistakes after shipping or invoicing.	2
crm_setup	CRM Setup & Navigation	Codes, statuses and setup values the CRM forms depend on.	3
customer_follow_up	Customer Follow-up	Interactions, tasks and relationship management.	3
form_field_catalog	Form & Field Guide	Where each form and key field is, and what it means.	2
faq	Cross-Process Guide	Questions that span several modules, end to end.	3

5. Writing the knowledge document

Copy SyteLine_Module_Knowledge_Template.md (Markdown, any text editor) or the .docx (Word). Both have the same sections. Grey notes in the template explain each section and may be left in.

5.1 Document Metadata (top of the file)

Field	What to write	Example
Module	The file name without .md	credit
SyteLine Forms	Exact form names used	Customers, Customer Orders
Tags	5–10 words users use for this module — added to every section's keywords	credit hold, blocked order, on hold
Access Level	SyteLine groups that use it	AR Clerk, Credit Manager
Document Owner / Reviewed By	Who wrote it / which business owner approved it, with date	R. Singh (Credit team), 2026-10-02
Last Reviewed / Version / Source	Date, version number, where the content came from	2026-10-02 · 1.0 · Credit SOP v3

Metadata, Table of Contents and Change History are for people — the chatbot does not search them.

5.2 The sections

Section	Write...	Answers questions like
Purpose / Overview	What the record means for our business, in 2–4 sentences	What is a credit hold?
Scope	What this document covers and what it doesn't	—
Roles and Permissions	Which groups can view / create / change / approve	Why can't I release this hold?
Prerequisites and Setup	What must exist first: master data, codes, parameters	What do I need before ...?
Forms and Navigation	Each form, how to open it, what it's for	Where do I set the credit limit?
Key Fields	Field · form · meaning · mandatory · allowed values	What does Credit Hold Reason mean?
One section per task	Path, preconditions, numbered steps, buttons, result and next step	How do I release a credit hold?
Status Lifecycle	Every status, its meaning, what moves it on	Why is my order still Planned?
Business Rules and Validations	Rules the system enforces, with the exact messages	Why does it say 'credit limit exceeded'?
What Comes Before and After	Where this module sits in the flow and how to move on	What do I do after the order is released?
Common Issues and Resolutions	Issue · exact error message · cause · solution · who can fix it	My order is still blocked, why?
Best Practices	Recommended ways of working	Any tips for ...?
Glossary	Terms of this module with nicknames and abbreviations	What does RMA mean?

5.3 Writing rules

- **One topic per ## section, under ~1,000 characters** (5–15 lines). Longer sections are split and can lose their heading.
- **Name tasks the way users ask:** "How to release a credit hold", not "Credit Hold Maintenance".
- **Exact SyteLine names** for forms, fields, buttons and statuses — as shown on screen.
- **Numbered steps** in the real order; one action per step.
- **Quote system messages exactly:** Error: "Credit limit exceeded for customer".
- **Every section ends with ****Section Summary:****** (one sentence) and ****Keywords:**** (users' words).
- **Don't know?** Write [NEEDS CONFIRMATION]. Never guess company rules, limits or codes.

- **Text only:** no screenshots or images — describe what the screen shows.

5.4 Tables

Tables are welcome. The chatbot turns every row into a sentence — "Field: Credit Limit · Form: Customers · Meaning: Maximum the customer may owe" — and searches each row on its own, so a question about one field finds its row. The answer is then written from the whole table.

- **Header row with clear column names** (Field, Form, Meaning, Allowed values).
- **First column = what users ask about:** the field, status, term or form name.
- **One fact per row; short cells.** No long paragraphs inside cells, no merged cells, no empty header.
- **One or two plain sentences above the table** saying what it is about.
- **Steps are not a table:** write procedures as numbered lists.

5.5 Good and bad keywords

	Example
Good	release credit hold, unblock order, knock off hold, order on hold, credit block
Bad	credit, order, system, process (too general — match everything)
Bad	CreditHoldMaintenanceProcedure (nobody types this)

5.6 Never put in any file

- Customer or employee names, e-mail addresses, phone numbers
- Real order, invoice or customer numbers, prices, balances, bank details
- Passwords, keys, internal server names or links

The checker (section 8) blocks e-mail addresses, phone numbers and passwords automatically.

6. Filling the Q&A workbook

Save a copy of SyteLine_QA_Template.xlsx per module (credit.xlsx). Red column headers are required; point at any header to read its note. Delete the blue example rows before sending.

6.1 Sheet qa_master — one row per question

Column	What to put
qa_id	Unique id, never reused: KB-0001. Ask the chatbot team for your number range.
module	The file name, e.g. credit
intent	HELP_GENERIC (what is) · HELP_PROCESS (how / why) · HELP_FIELD (a field) · HELP_SCREEN (a form) · TROUBLESHOOTING (why can't I / error)
canonical_question	The clearest way to ask it, ending with ?
answer	1–4 sentences or a few short steps (under ~600 characters). Shown WORD FOR WORD.
keywords / synonyms	Users' words, comma-separated / other names separated with
source_reference / section	The knowledge document and section it comes from — they must agree
security_scope	ALL, or the SyteLine groups allowed to see it (AR_CLERK CREDIT_MANAGER)
approval_status	DRAFT → IN_REVIEW → APPROVED (or REJECTED). Only APPROVED rows are used.
approved_by / effective_date	Required when APPROVED: reviewer name + team, and a date
active	TRUE; FALSE switches a row off without deleting it

6.2 Sheet question_variations

At least 3 per question, in users' own words — casual, short, with slang or typos. Record where each came from (user interview, help-desk ticket, chatbot log, SME).

qa_id	variation_id	question_variation	source
KB-0001	V1	how to release credit hold	user_interview
KB-0001	V2	order is blocked by credit, how to unblock	helpdesk_ticket
KB-0001	V3	knock off the credit hold pls	chatbot_log

6.3 Sheet glossary

canonical_term	synonyms (separate with)	abbreviation	module
Customer Order	sales order SO order	CO	customer_order
Credit Hold	credit block on hold blocked order		credit

6.4 Approval workflow

Status	Meaning	Used by the chatbot?
DRAFT	Written, not checked	No
IN_REVIEW	With the business owner	No
APPROVED	Checked by the business owner (approved_by + effective_date filled)	Yes, if active = TRUE
REJECTED	Not correct — kept for history	No

7. Writing in Word instead of Markdown

Use SyteLine_Module_Knowledge_Template.docx. Keep the Heading 1 / Heading 2 styles, the numbered and bullet list styles, and the bold 'Label:' at the start of lines (Section Summary:, Keywords:, Path:). Then convert it:

```
python -m scripts.convert_docx_to_md credit.docx
→ creates credit.md (the file the chatbot loads)
```

Grey italic 'Note:' paragraphs are removed automatically. Tables stay tables.

8. Check your files before sending

Run the checker on your files or the whole folder. It changes nothing; it tells you what to fix and shows exactly how the chatbot will split your document into sections.

```
python -m scripts.validate_knowledge_data credit.md credit.xlsx
python -m scripts.validate_knowledge_data my_delivery_folder
```

Mark	Meaning	What to do
✓	Ready	Send it
⚠	Quality warning (e.g. no Keywords, section too long, open [NEEDS CONFIRMATION], fewer than 3 variations)	Fix if you can; explain the rest when you send
✗	Error (e.g. placeholder left in, personal data, missing column, APPROVED without reviewer)	Must be fixed before sending

Example of a clean result:

```
⚠ credit.md
  ⚠ 1 [NEEDS CONFIRMATION] item(s) still open (lines 69)
  → will be indexed as 6 searchable section(s):
    1. 1. Purpose / Overview          431 chars · keywords: yes
    4. 4. How to release a credit hold 820 chars · keywords: yes
```

1 file(s) checked · 0 error(s) · 1 warning(s) – ready to send

9. Quality checklist (per module)

✓	Check
☐	File names = module id, same for .md and .xlsx
☐	Metadata filled: owner, reviewer, dates, version, source, tags
☐	Every task users do has its own section with numbered steps and 'what happens next'
☐	Form, field, button and status names match SyteLine exactly
☐	Exact error messages quoted; common issues have cause, solution and who can fix
☐	Every section has a Section Summary and Keywords with users' words
☐	No guessed rules — unknowns marked [NEEDS CONFIRMATION]
☐	No personal data, real numbers, prices or passwords
☐	Q&A answers are short and agree with the knowledge document
☐	At least 3 variations per question; glossary has every abbreviation
☐	Rows reviewed by the business owner and set to APPROVED with approved_by and date
☐	Checker shows 0 errors

10. How to hand over

Step	What happens	Who
1	Put the module's files in one folder named after the module (credit/credit.md, credit/credit.xlsx) and zip it	Data team
2	Send it with the checker output and a list of open [NEEDS CONFIRMATION] items	Data team
3	We load it, restart the chatbot and ask 10–20 test questions per module	Chatbot team
4	Wrong or missing answers come back to you as a list (from the feedback console's content gaps)	Chatbot team → data team
5	Fix, re-check, re-send; the business owner approves the final version	Data team + owner

Keeping it current

When a process, form or rule changes in SyteLine, update the module file, raise its Version, set Last Reviewed, and re-send. Review every module at least once per quarter.

11. Questions the data team often asks

Question	Answer
Can I reuse our HRMS document style?	Yes — the template follows it (metadata, contents, sections with Section Summary and Keywords, glossary). Differences: SyteLine sections for roles, forms, fields, statuses and what comes next.
Markdown or Word?	Either. Markdown loads directly; Word is converted with one command.
How long should a document be?	As long as needed, but each ## section short (5–15 lines). A typical module has 10–20 sections.
Does the same answer go in both files?	The document has the full explanation; the workbook has the short approved answer. They must agree.
What if something differs between sites?	Say so in the text ("At the EAST site ...") and set site_scope in the workbook.
Can the chatbot use screenshots?	No — it reads text only. Describe the screen instead.